F-9. Community Forest Management

Measure Type	Cost	Preferences by Community	Hazards	Implementation Time of Measures
 Forest / Shrub Land Conservation	৳ Low	 High		

Descriptions

Measures	Community Forest Management (CFM) is a collaborative approach to managing forest resources in which local communities or indigenous groups are actively involved in decision-making, planning, and implementation of forest management activities. The goal of CFM is to ensure the sustainable use and conservation of forest ecosystems while improving the livelihoods of the communities that depend on them. In Bangladesh's CHT, Community Forest Management (CFM) can be successfully used through a variety of strategies catered to the distinct ecological and socioeconomic circumstances of the area. Sustainable land and water management, forest protection and conservation, sustainable harvesting and resource management, and community empowerment are a few examples of these. A sustainable community forest management system in the CHT can be established with the help of these measures when they are applied comprehensively and integratedly. This will guarantee that the area's rich forests continue to offer essential ecosystem services, boost community resilience, and raise locals' standard of living.

Location	R-114	R-99	R-65	K-98	K-76	K-71	B-173	B-77	B-76
	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■

Applicable Sites	Suitable for degraded lands, barren area, low forest

Slope	Less than 3%	3% to 15%	15% to 30%	30% to 60%	Above 60%
	√	√			

Feasibility criteria	• Examination of the forest areas' ecological parameters, including biodiversity, soil fertility, water availability, and forest cover, is necessary to make sure the land is appropriate for community-led management. Natural regrowth should be possible in the local forests, and sustainable forest product extraction practices are necessary to prevent resource depletion or harm over time. • Integrating local communities will contribute customs, knowledge, and a common understanding of forest resources. The program's implementation expenses must be surpassed by the financial gains from CFM, such as revenue from ecotourism, non-timber forest products (NTFPs), and sustainable timber harvesting. • To preserve the health and productivity of forests, the CFM program must be flexible enough to adjust to new environmental factors and climate variability, such as rising rainfall, droughts, or temperature fluctuations.

	• There should be a system in place for regularly monitoring on the health of the forest, how resources are being used, and how the community is doing. This ensures that CFM procedures are continuously evaluated, modified, and enhanced in response to performance and evolving circumstances.
Operation and maintenance	To ensure the long-term sustainability of forest resources and the welfare of the community, Community Forest Management (CFM) in the CHT entails a number of crucial tasks. Among these tasks is routine monitoring of forest health, including soil quality, biodiversity, and tree growth. To stop unlawful actions like poaching or deforestation, there must be regular patrols and security measures. Adaptive management techniques and appropriate documentation enable ongoing development in response to social or environmental issues.
Cost	Low
Benefits	

Type	**Low**	**Medium**	**High**
Canopy Cover Increase			
Carbon Sequestration			
Crop Production Increase			
Crop Failure Risk Reduction			
Ensuring Food Security			
Fruit Production Increase			
Forestry Goods Production Increase			
Livestock Production Increase			
Fisheries Production Increase			
Alternative Livelihood Generation			
Increase of Income			
Soil Erosion Control			
Improved Soil Health			
Soil Fertility Increase			
Sustainable Water Supply			
Water Quality Improvement			
Water Purification			
River Bank Erosion Control			
Surface Runoff Reduction			
Groundwater Recharge			
Pest and Disease Management			
Reduction of Pesticides and Fertilizer Use			
Ecosystem and Biodiversity Increase			
Better Communications			
Better Education			
Better WASH facilities			

Implementation Challenges	

	Type	Low	Medium	High
	Land unavailable/high land area required			
	Supply chain disconnection			
	Land right related problems			
	High human investment capital need			
	Insufficient infrastructures			
	Less demand of agroforestry product			
	Environmentally unsustainable			
	Socially unacceptable			
	Less beneficial			
Environmental performance	• Through preserving biodiversity, preventing exploitation of natural resources, and protecting wildlife habitats, CFM contributes to the protection of varied ecosystems. Restoring damaged forest lands through sustainable methods like managed timber harvesting and controlled grazing encourages the regrowth of native plant species. • Harvesting wood and non-timber forest products sustainably preserves the forest ecosystem while giving local communities access to vital resources. Through resource management, CFM lessens the strain on primary forests, limiting deforestation and fostering long-term sustainability. • Forest ecosystems that endure environmental stressors like invasive species or climate change are healthier and more robust when regular monitoring and adaptive management are implemented. Through conservation initiatives, CFM supports a variety of plant and animal species and contributes to the general health of ecosystems.			
Remarks	This measure will aid landscape restoration in CHT of Bangladesh along with creating alternative livelihood opportunities.			